Quarterly inspection report — Q3 2026

Northgate Footbridge (structure ref. FB-112) · synthetic sample

1 Summary

The footbridge was inspected on 22 September 2026 by a team of two engineers, working from the deck and from a boat. The structure remains in fair condition. Eight defects were recorded; none of them requires the bridge to be closed or a weight limit to be imposed. Three defects are new since the last inspection.

2 Load test

A static load test was carried out at midspan with a uniformly distributed test load of 5.0 kN/m². The maximum deflection under the test load was 12.6 mm, against a calculated value of 13.5 mm and a limit of 18.0 mm. The residual deflection after unloading was 0.4 mm, which is within the expected range.

3 Inspection zones

The bridge is divided into four inspection zones, shown on the site plan: Z1 west abutment, Z2 west span, Z3 east span and Z4 east abutment. The defect register lists each defect with its zone, the element concerned and the action we recommend.

4 Access and weather

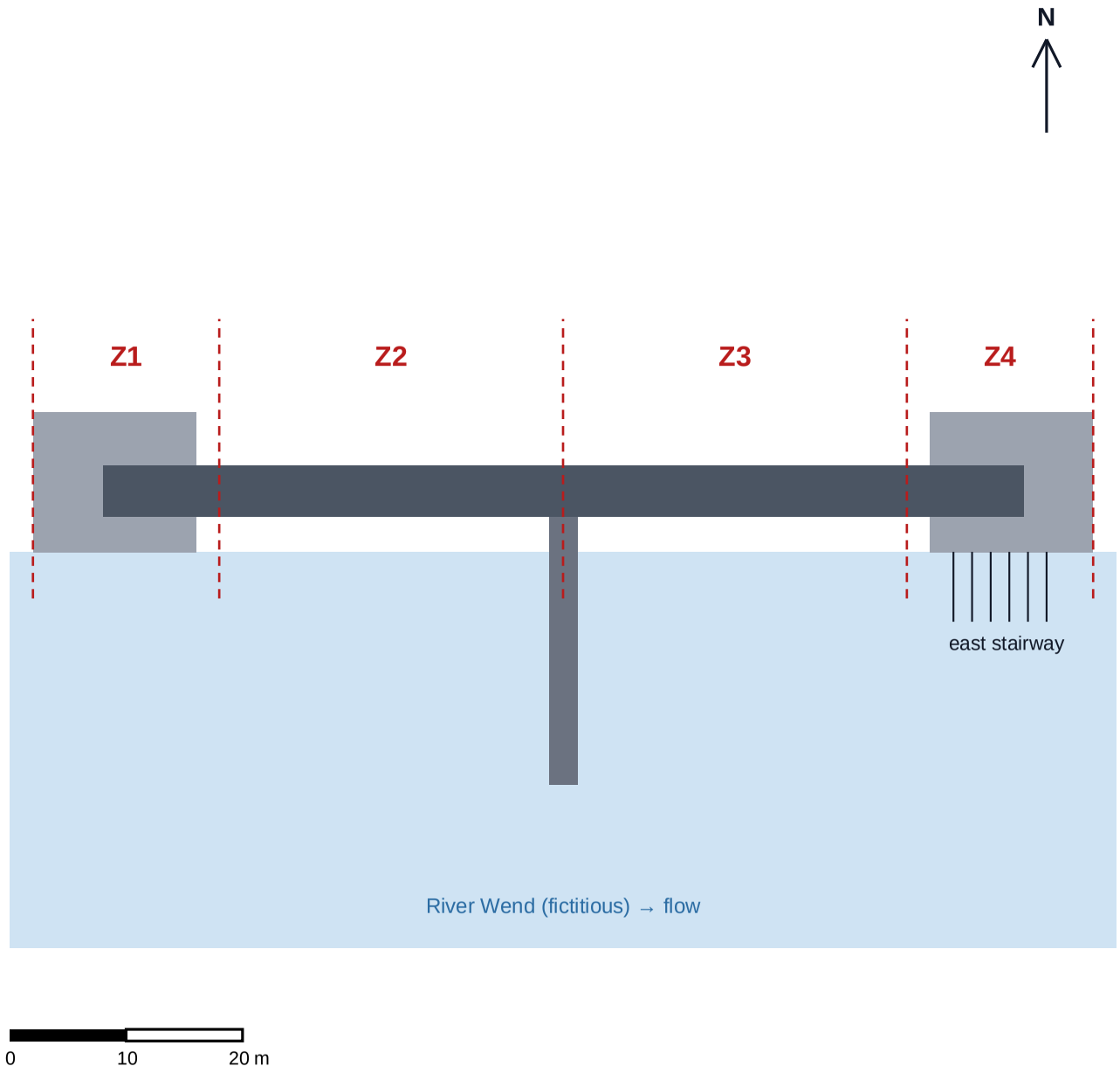
The inspection took place in dry weather with a light westerly wind. The river level was 0.6 m below the normal summer level, so that the lower parts of both abutments could be inspected from the boat. The east stairway was closed to the public for two hours while the load test was carried out.

Previous inspections

Inspection	Date	Defects	Condition
Q4 2025	9 December 2025	5	Fair
Q1 2026	17 March 2026	6	Fair
Q2 2026	23 June 2026	5	Fair
Q3 2026	22 September 2026	8	Fair

Site plan — inspection zones

Northgate Footbridge FB-112 · Q3 2026 inspection · not to scale · synthetic sample



Legend

- Bridge deck, steel box girder, 46 m
- Abutments
- Pier
- Zone boundary (dashed)

FB-112 Northgate Footbridge — defect register Q3 2026

Ref	Zone	Element	Defect	Severity	Recommended action	Due
D-01	Z1	Abutment wall	Vertical crack, 0.3 mm wide, 1.1 m long	Low	Monitor; measure at next inspection	Q4 2026
D-02	Z1	Expansion joint	Seal torn over 40 cm, water ingress	Medium	Re-seal joint (PW-1)	Q4 2026
D-03	Z2	Handrail post	Corrosion at base, section loss about 15 %	Medium	Replace post (PW-2)	Q4 2026
D-04	Z2	Handrail post	Corrosion at base, section loss about 10 %	Medium	Replace post (PW-2)	Q4 2026
D-05	Z2	Deck surfacing	Worn anti-slip coating, 2 m²	Low	Patch at next resurfacing	Q3 2027
D-06	Z3	Drainage outlet	Blocked by leaves and silt	Low	Clear outlet	Q4 2026
D-07	Z4	Bearing shelf	Debris and surface rust on bearing plates	Medium	Clean and repaint (PW-3)	Q1 2027
D-08	Z4	East stairway	Spalled concrete on two treads, rebar exposed	Medium	Repair concrete (PW-4)	Q2 2027

5 Recommendations

We recommend that the works below are carried out in the order shown. Works marked for Q4 2026 should be ordered now, so that they can be completed before the winter. The budget figures are estimates at today’s prices and do not include traffic management on the river.

Ref	Work	Quarter	Budget (EU
PW-1	Re-seal the expansion joint at the east abutment	Q4 2026	4,8
PW-2	Replace two corroded handrail posts in zone Z2	Q4 2026	2,3
PW-3	Clean and repaint the bearing shelf at the west abutment	Q1 2027	6,9
PW-4	Repair spalled concrete on the east stairway	Q2 2027	3,1

The total budget for the planned works is EUR 17,200. Works PW-1 and PW-2 can be carried out by the maintenance contractor under the existing framework agreement.

6 Next inspection

The next quarterly inspection is planned for December 2026. The next principal inspection, with access to all parts of the structure, is due in March 2028.

7 Sign-off

Inspected by: R. Albrecht, chartered engineer, and S. Adeyemi, inspector. Checked by: L. Varga, bridge manager.